

# **Report: Potential Risks with File Transfers**

File transfers are essential to daily operations in modern organizations, enabling the exchange of information between users, systems, and external partners. However, transferring files introduces security and operational risks that must be managed appropriately.

## **1. Data Interception**

Files transmitted using insecure protocols such as FTP or HTTP may be intercepted by attackers, resulting in unauthorized access to sensitive information.

## **2. Malware Distribution**

Malicious files can be uploaded or shared through file transfer systems. These files may contain ransomware, trojans, or other malicious software.

## **3. Unauthorized Access**

Weak authentication, poor password practices, or excessive permissions may allow unauthorized users to access, modify, or delete files.

## **4. Data Leakage**

Sensitive documents may be shared with unintended recipients or exposed through misconfigured file sharing services.

## **5. Integrity and Availability Risks**

Files can become corrupted during transfer, lost because of interrupted connections, or rendered unavailable by hardware failures and service outages.

## Recommended Mitigations

- Use encrypted protocols such as SFTP, SCP, or HTTPS.
- Enforce strong authentication and multi-factor authentication where possible.
- Apply least-privilege access controls.
- Scan uploaded files for malware.
- Maintain audit logs of file access and transfers.
- Create regular backups and test restoration procedures.
- Monitor unusual upload and download activity.

Conclusion: Secure file transfer practices significantly reduce the likelihood of data breaches, malware infections, and operational disruptions.